



**KOALAS
SLEEP
UP TO**

20

**HOURS
EACH
DAY**

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Koala

⚠️ IUCN status: vulnerable

👤 Population estimate: 100,000–500,000

KEY

📍 Koala range

Keeping cool

In northeastern Australia, where the climate is very hot, koalas have shorter, paler, fur to help keep them cool.

Facing forward

The koala is the only marsupial with forward-facing eyes. This makes it a better judge of distance, which is important for clambering through branches without falling.

Following eucalyptus

Though koalas are found in a range of habitats, from subtropical forests to grasslands and savannas, their range is dependent on the presence of eucalyptus trees, the leaves of which make up the large majority of their diet. Much of their habitat has been lost due to logging, forest clearing, and bushfires, putting many koala populations at risk of extinction.

Tough digestion

The leaves of eucalyptus are hard and fibrous, making them very difficult to digest. They quickly fill the stomach of a browsing koala, but provide little nutrition, meaning that when they are not eating or sleeping, koalas spend their time resting to conserve energy.

